Abdullah Al Zahid

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Hiring Manager
Transportation Planning
City of Mississauga, Transportation and Works Department

Re: Project Leader, Transportation (Req ID 28672)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Project Leader, Transportation position in Transportation Planning. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, and the work you describe, studies and policy that support a multi-modal transportation plan, is the work I do now at a smaller scale.

At the City I analyze travel and network data, including several years of the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, to show where capacity falls short. I review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, advise on by-laws and regulations, and write the briefing notes and reports that carry findings to senior staff. I coordinate with divisions, consultants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations. Before that, at Metrolinx, I used OpenTrack to assess rail operating changes, and at Mott MacDonald I modelled road closures for Ontario Line construction staging in Synchro.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have about four and a half years of experience, counting my graduate research, which is short of the five the posting asks for. I am not a registered professional engineer or a member of the Ontario Professional Planners Institute. I have not led a Transportation Master Plan or a Development Charges background study, I have not worked on the Class Environmental Assessment process. I am applying because the analysis and writing underneath the role are what I do each day, and I would welcome the chance to take on the project leadership.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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